

Absolutely — **spark** is a strong polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “...where it could soften the mood, **spark conversation**, and remind me to slow down once in a while.”

Here **spark** is figurative. It means **to cause something to begin**, specifically to **start or stimulate conversation**. But **spark** also has major meanings involving **tiny flashes of fire/electricity, sudden energy or interest, chemistry/romance, conflict, and ignition**.

Word family: **spark / sparked / sparking / sparkly / sparkle**

Base word: spark

Verb forms: spark, sparks, sparked, sparking

Related noun/verb: sparkle

Related adjective: sparkly

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Meaning in your passage: **spark = cause something to begin** — 引發；激起；觸發

Your sentence:

> “...it could **spark conversation**...”

Here **spark** means:

> **to cause a conversation, reaction, idea, interest, or event to begin.**

繁體中文：

使某件事開始發生；引發、激起、觸發

Natural translation:

> “...it could spark conversation...”

「它可以**引發話題 / 帶起談話**。」

So here:

> **spark conversation = 引發談話 / 開啟話題**

1. **spark = tiny flash of fire/light** — 火花

The core literal noun meaning.

Practice 1

> “A **spark** flew from the fire.”

「火堆裡飛出一點**火花**。」

Practice 2

> “The metal produced sparks when it hit the ground.”

「金屬撞到地面時產生了**火花**。」

spark = 燃燒、摩擦或撞擊時產生的一小點亮光 / 火星

2. **spark** = small electrical discharge — 電火花；火花放電

A major technical meaning.

Practice 3

> “A small electrical **spark** jumped between the wires.”

「兩條電線之間出現了一個小**電火花**。」

Practice 4

> “The faulty switch produced a spark.”

「故障的開關產生了**電火花**。」

spark = 電流瞬間跳過空隙時出現的小型放電

3. **spark** = cause a fire/ignite — 點燃；引起燃燒

A literal verb meaning.

Practice 5

> “The damaged wire **sparked** a fire.”

「損壞的電線**引發了火災**。」

Practice 6

> “A cigarette can spark a wildfire in dry conditions.”

「在乾燥情況下，一支香煙也可能**引發山火**。」

spark = 產生火花並令某物開始燃燒

4. **spark = cause something to begin — 引發；觸發**

This is your exact source sense.

Practice 7 — Original

> “The painting could **spark conversation**.”

「這幅畫可以**引發談話 / 帶起話題**。」

Practice 8

> “The exhibition sparked a lot of discussion.”

「這個展覽**引發了很多討論**。」

spark = 令某個活動、反應、討論、變化等開始發生

5. **spark = stimulate interest/curiosity — 激起興趣；引發好奇**

A very common figurative use.

Practice 9

> “The painting **sparked** my interest in Impressionism.”

「這幅畫**激起了我對印象派的興趣**。」

Practice 10

> “Her question sparked my curiosity.”

「她的問題**引起了我的好奇心**。」

****spark = 令某種興趣、好奇、想法或感情突然開始****

6. ****spark = cause an idea/inspiration — 激發；啟發****

Practice 11

> “The trip ****sparked**** an idea for a new project.”

「這趟旅程**激發了**一個新項目的想法。」

Practice 12

> “The colours sparked his imagination.”

「那些色彩**激發了他的想像力**。」

****spark = 促使一個新想法、靈感或創意開始形成****

7. ****spark = cause conflict/reaction — 引發；掀起****

A common news/general-use sense.

Practice 13

> “The decision ****sparked**** protests.”

「這個決定**引發了抗議**。」

Practice 14

> “The comment sparked an argument.”

「那句評論**引起了爭論**。」

****spark = 引發較強烈的反應、衝突或連鎖事件****

Common:

* spark debate

* spark controversy

* spark protests

* spark anger

8. **spark = small sign of energy/interest/talent — 一絲；一點火花**

A figurative noun meaning.

Practice 15

> “There was a **spark** of excitement in her voice.”

「她的聲音裡帶著一絲**興奮**。」

Practice 16

> “The performance lacked a real spark.”

「這場表演缺少真正的**活力 / 亮點**。」

spark = 少量但明顯的活力、情感、興趣或特色

9. **spark = lively energy / special quality — 活力；火花；神采**

Practice 17

> “She brings a real **spark** to the team.”

「她為團隊帶來真正的**活力 / 朝氣**。」

Practice 18

> “The room needs something to give it more spark.”

「這個房間需要一些東西來增加**生氣 / 亮點**。」

spark = 令某人 / 某物顯得有活力、有趣或吸引人的特質

10. **spark = romantic chemistry/attraction — 火花；來電感**

A common figurative relationship sense.

Practice 19

> “There was an immediate **spark** between them.”

「他們之間立刻產生了**火花 / 來電的感覺**。」

Practice 20

> “They got along well, but there was no spark.”

「他們相處得很好，但彼此之間沒有那種**火花 / 吸引力**。」

spark = 兩人之間突然產生的浪漫吸引力或強烈化學反應

11. **sparks fly = 火花四濺 ; 比喻激烈衝突 / 強烈化學反應**

A useful fixed expression.

Practice 21

> “Sparks flew during the debate.”

「辯論中**火花四濺 / 衝突非常激烈**。」

Practice 22

> “Sparks flew the moment they met.”

「他們一見面就產生了強烈的**化學反應 / 火花**。」

sparks fly = 情緒、爭論或吸引力突然變得非常強烈

12. **spark plug = 火星塞 ; 火花塞**

A common mechanical compound.

Practice 23

> “The engine needs a new **spark plug**.”

「引擎需要換一個新的**火星塞**。」

Practice 24

> “A faulty spark plug can affect engine performance.”

「故障的**火星塞**會影響引擎性能。」

spark plug = 在汽油引擎內產生火花以點燃燃料混合物的零件

13. **spark = ignition signal in engine — 點火火花**

A technical automotive use.

Practice 25

> “The engine is not getting a strong **spark**.”

「引擎沒有得到足夠強的**點火火花**。」

Practice 26

> “The mechanic checked the spark.”

「技師檢查了**點火火花**。」

spark — engine = 用來點燃燃料的電火花

14. **spark = sudden burst of thought/emotion — 一瞬間的念頭 / 情緒**

A figurative noun extension.

Practice 27

> “A **spark** of hope returned.”

「一絲**希望**重新出現。」

Practice 28

> “The idea began with a tiny spark of inspiration.”

「這個想法源自一點小小的**靈感火花**。」

****spark = 某種想法、情感或希望突然出現的一小點開端****

15. ****sparkle = shine with many small flashes — 閃耀；閃爍****

A useful related family word.

Practice 29

> “The water ****sparkled**** in the sunlight.”

「水面在陽光下****閃閃發亮****。」

Practice 30

> “Her eyes sparkled with excitement.”

「她的眼睛因興奮而****閃閃發亮****。」

****sparkle = 發出很多細小、明亮而快速變化的閃光****

16. ****sparkle = show lively energy/charm — 神采奕奕；充滿活力****

A figurative extension.

Practice 31

> “Her conversation ****sparkled**** with humour.”

「她的談話充滿幽默和****神采****。」

Practice 32

> “The performance sparkled from beginning to end.”

「這場表演由始至終都****充滿活力 / 亮點****。」

****sparkle = 表現出活潑、機智、魅力或生氣****

17. ****sparkly = 閃閃發亮的；閃亮的****

Practice 33

> “She wore a **sparkly** dress.”

「她穿了一條**閃亮亮的**裙子。」

Practice 34

> “The decorations were bright and sparkly.”

「那些裝飾又明亮又**閃閃發光**。」

sparkly = 表面有很多細小閃光、亮點的

Register:

* informal

* very common in everyday descriptions

Important distinction: **spark** vs **flame**

spark

= tiny flash/particle of fire.

flame

= visible burning gas/fire itself.

> spark

> = 火花

> flame

> = 火焰

A spark can start a flame.

Important distinction: **spark** vs **flash**

spark

often:

- * tiny point of fire/electricity
- * beginning of something figuratively

flash

= brief burst of light.

> electric spark

> = 電火花

> camera flash

> = 相機閃光

Not the same.

Important distinction: **spark vs sparkle**

spark

noun:

= one small flash/fire point

sparkle

verb/noun:

= repeated small flashes

> a spark

> = 一點火花

> water sparkles

> = 水面閃閃發光

Important distinction: **spark vs ignite**

ignite

= set something on fire / begin burning.

spark

= can literally ignite something, or figuratively trigger something.

> spark a fire

> = 引發火災

> ignite a fire

> = 點燃火

In figurative language, both can mean “trigger,” but **spark** often suggests the initial trigger.

Important distinction: **spark vs trigger**

trigger

= cause something to happen, often directly and mechanically.

spark

= start or stimulate something, often dynamically or suddenly.

> trigger an alarm

> = 觸發警報

> spark a discussion

> = 引發討論

Spark often feels more natural for:

* ideas

* debate

* interest

* conversation

Important distinction: **spark vs cause**

cause

neutral and broad.

spark

suggests:

> the initial event that starts a reaction/process.

> “The announcement caused concern.”

= 公告引起擔憂。

> “The announcement sparked debate.”

= 公告引發一連串辯論。

Important distinction: **spark** vs **inspire**

spark

= start an idea/interest.

inspire

= fill someone with motivation or creative influence.

> “The painting sparked an idea.”

= 畫作讓一個想法開始出現。

> “The painting inspired me to paint.”

= 畫作啟發我去畫畫。

Close, but **spark** emphasizes the beginning.

Important distinction: **spark** vs **stimulate**

stimulate

= encourage activity/development.

spark

= set off the initial beginning.

> stimulate discussion

> = 促進討論

> spark discussion

> = 引發討論

The first emphasizes continuation/activity; the second initiation.

Important distinction: ****spark conversation vs start conversation****

****start a conversation****

neutral:

= 開始談話。

****spark conversation****

suggests:

= 某件事自然引起大家想談、交換意見。

In your passage, the painting itself acts as the stimulus.

So:

> spark conversation

> = ****引發話題 / 帶起談話****

is more expressive than simply “start”.

Important distinction: ****spark — literal vs figurative****

Literal:

> “A spark started the fire.”

= 一點火花引起火災。

Figurative:

> “The painting sparked a conversation.”

= 畫作引發談話。

Underlying metaphor:

- > small spark → starts a fire
- > small stimulus → starts a larger reaction

Important distinction: ****spark — interest vs romantic spark****

Interest:

- > “The book sparked my interest.”

= 這本書引起我的興趣。

Romance:

- > “There was a spark between them.”

= 他們之間有火花 / 來電感。

Same metaphor, different domain.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

- * ****spark — fire**** = 火花
- * ****spark — electricity**** = 電火花
- * ****spark — ignite**** = 點燃 / 引發火災
- * ****spark — cause to begin**** = 引發 / 觸發
- * ****spark — interest/curiosity**** = 激起興趣 / 好奇
- * ****spark — idea/inspiration**** = 激發靈感 / 想法
- * ****spark — conflict/reaction**** = 引發抗議 / 爭議 / 反應
- * ****spark — small sign of emotion/energy**** = 一絲 / 一點火花
- * ****spark — liveliness**** = 活力 / 神采
- * ****spark — romantic attraction**** = 火花 / 來電感
- * ****sparks fly**** = 激烈衝突 / 強烈化學反應
- * ****spark plug**** = 火星塞
- * ****spark — engine ignition**** = 點火火花
- * ****sparkle — literal**** = 閃耀 / 閃爍
- * ****sparkle — figurative**** = 充滿神采 / 活力
- * ****sparkly**** = 閃閃發亮的

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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spark — fire	燃燒、摩擦或撞擊時產生的一小點亮光 / 火星
spark — electrical	電流瞬間跳過空隙時產生的小型電火花
spark — ignite	因火花或點火作用令某物開始燃燒
spark — trigger	使某個活動、反應、討論或事件開始發生
spark — interest	令某種興趣、好奇或注意突然開始
spark — inspiration	促使新的想法或創意開始形成
spark — conflict/reaction	引起抗議、爭議、憤怒等較強烈反應
a spark — emotion/energy	少量但明顯的情感、希望、活力或特色
spark — liveliness	令人 / 事物顯得有生氣、有趣或吸引人的特質
spark — romance	兩人之間突然產生的浪漫吸引力 / 化學反應
spark plug	汽油引擎中產生火花點燃燃料的零件
sparkle — literal	發出許多細小而快速變化的亮光
sparkle — figurative	表現出機智、活力、魅力或神采
sparkly	表面有很多細小亮點、閃閃發光的

For your original sentence

> “...where it could soften the mood, ****spark conversation****, and remind me to slow down once in a while.”

The exact meaning is:

****spark conversation = 這幅畫可能會令看到它的人自然產生想法、問題或感受，從而開始交談****

Natural translation:

> ****「……它可以柔化氣氛、引發話題，也提醒我偶爾放慢腳步。」****

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > ****a spark from a fire**** → 火花
- > ****electrical spark**** → 電火花
- > ****spark a fire**** → 引發火災
- > ****spark conversation**** → 引發談話 / 帶起話題
- > ****spark interest**** → 激起興趣
- > ****spark an idea**** → 激發想法
- > ****spark controversy**** → 引發爭議
- > ****a spark of hope**** → 一絲希望

> ****romantic spark**** → 戀愛火花 / 來電感

> ****sparkle**** → 閃耀 / 充滿神采